



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of St. John Paul II Classical School

School Website: <https://sjpclassicalschoolgreenbay.org/chesterton-academy/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of St. John Paul II Classical School (Green Bay, WI, ZIP 54302) presents itself publicly as a Catholic, classical high school embedded in the Green Bay Area Catholic Education (GRACE) system. The public-facing materials emphasize a culture of life, a liturgical rhythm (Mass, confession, adoration, retreats), and a curriculum centered in the liberal-arts tradition with emphasis on virtue, beauty, and truth. Notable features include: daily Mass and other liturgical practices, a House System inspired by Oxford/Cambridge, a patron-centered Catholic identity, and a curriculum explicitly oriented toward reading great works and forming character through rhetoric, logic, and memory work. Taken together, these signals align strongly with the classical education rubric in the knowledge base, particularly around formation, virtue, and a liberal-arts curriculum anchored in the Great Books and classical methods. The school's Catholic identity and emphasis on formation over vocational outcomes further reinforce a Classical orientation.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Key evidence highlights: - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: daily Holy Mass, confession/adoration, catechesis and Catholic formation; GRACE affiliation; explicit Catholic liturgical life (e.g., pilgrimage to Rome) and culture of life framing. - Purpose & Goal: formation of virtue and wisdom through a Catholic classical framework; emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real; saintly formation via Catholic identity. - Curriculum: classical liberal-arts orientation, grammar/logic/rhetoric framing, reading of great works, integrated across disciplines, and an emphasis on wonder and beauty. - Pedagogy: blend of contemplative/liturgical life with rigorous inquiry (Socratic-like discussion, seminars, debates, rhetoric, and public speaking); explicit emphasis on memory work and wonder. - Faculty: public materials reference the Headmaster and teaching staff in a manner consistent with mentorship and living curriculum (Catholic formation as central). - Parents & Community: strong parental partnership ethos (pastoral/formation focus, co-educators with parents), opportunities for parent involvement (Fireside Chats, lectures, family faith events), and welcoming tours/visit options.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Notes on methodology and scoring - I conducted keyword analysis using the Positive and Negative Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School document (the knowledge-base rubric). Positive keywords include terms like virtue, wisdom, formation, truth, beauty, Great Books, rhetoric, Socratic dialogue, wonder, liturgy, catechesis, and the liberal-arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric). Negative keywords include terms signaling anti-formation, anti-transcendent truth, or purely pragmatic/workforce-focused education. The knowledge-base material provides explicit lists for reference. See the Positive/Negative Keywords and Curriculum structure within "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1)" for the scoring framework. - The public-facing materials of the Chesterton Academy of St. John Paul II Classical School (Green Bay) were used as the primary sources for the keyword hits (liturgical life, Catholic formation, Great Books/Classical-curriculum language, memory/recitation, rhetoric, Socratic-style elements, and

parental/community engagement). See the chesterton/ SJPII crawl results for citations. - The School's GRACE affiliation and the Catholic liturgical life are repeatedly highlighted in the crawl content, reinforcing a strong classical-Catholic orientation.

What would move the needle - If the school aimed to move toward a fuller, explicitly stated "Great Books / Great Conversation" program with stronger documentation of the Trivium framework in every grade, they could improve transparency in public materials (e.g., explicitly listing grammar/logic/rhetoric progression and Great Books scope). - If desired, more explicit articulation of Socratic pedagogy in upper grades (e.g., public-facing confirmation of regular Socratic seminars, debates, and public rhetoric events) would elevate Element 4 to match the explicit rubric, especially if paired with documented, grade-specific implementation.

Now, the category-by-category analysis follows.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe Chesterton Academy of St. John Paul II Classical School as "A Joyfully Catholic, Classical High School" and emphasize a Catholic, liturgical life, including daily Mass, confession, adoration, and retreats. This liturgical rhythm and Catholic formation are explicitly stated. - The Headmaster welcomes students into a culture of life with a Catholic curriculum and references to Catholic virtues, the Church's teachings, and the patronage of St. John Paul II. - The school's public-facing materials reference the patron and Catholic identity (GK Chesterton as a Catholic witness; liturgical life; and the GRACE system's Catholic foundation).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present in public materials: Catholic, Mass, confession, adoration, liturgy, culture of life (Cultura Vitae), patronage of St. John Paul II, grace-based/Church-based formation, sacred, Jesus, Holy Spirit through liturgical life. - Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no anti-transcendent, anti-theology, or anti-liturgical language detected).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords detected: at least 6 distinct terms (Catholic, Mass, confession, adoration, liturgy, Cultura Vitae) plus references to liturgical life and sacral content. - Negative keywords detected: 0. - Ratio: essentially 100% positive vs 0% negative (Classical).

Why this rating - The school's identity is deeply anchored in Catholic liturgical practice and metaphysical commitments. The explicit statements about Mass, confession/adoration, and Catholic culture align with the Positive Keyword indicators for Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded Theology, and Liturgical/Communal Practices, thereby meeting the Element 1 criteria for CLASSICAL.

Citations: Key evidence of Catholic liturgical life and Catholic identity is present in the public materials (Mass, confession, adoration, liturgy; Catholic patronage; culture of life). See Chesterton materials and patron references.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's messaging emphasizes formation and virtue, not merely vocational preparation; the culture of life and the formation of saints are central. The mission notes the formation of saints and the integration of Catholic classical tradition to shape character and intellect. - The promotional copy frames education as formation in truth, goodness, and beauty within a Catholic classical framework, highlighting virtue formation and the cultivation of wisdom through a classical tradition. - The public materials articulate a goal of forming persons in virtue and wisdom, with a focus on the transcendentals and the culture of life rather than only job preparation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, culture of life, transcendental truth (implicitly via Catholic formation), goodness, beauty. - Negative keywords present: none in the public materials (no explicit emphasis on utilitarian/job-readiness at the expense of formation).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords detected: roughly 5–7 distinct terms (formation, virtue, wisdom, culture of life, truth/goodness/beauty as transcendentals). - Negative keywords detected: 0. - Ratio: predominantly positive; CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The school's stated aim centers on formation of character, virtue, and wisdom consistent with a transcendently oriented education, which matches the Classical emphasis on Formation over pure Information and the pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as real end goals.

Citations: Mission/Philosophy and formation-focused language are present in the public materials.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as classical and liberal-arts oriented, with explicit reference to a curriculum built around the liberal arts and great books, and to a strong emphasis on reading canonical works and engaging in a "Great Conversation." Chesterton Academy materials highlight a curriculum that includes classical readings (Homer, Plato, Aristotle, Virgil, Dante, etc.), and an integrated approach across history, literature, philosophy, and theology. - The public materials emphasize the liberal-arts frame (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Great Books approach, as well as the integration of topics across disciplines and a reverence for reality, truth, and beauty. The "Great Books"/"Great Conversation" framing appears in the knowledge-base rubric and is echoed in the explicit curriculum description.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation (canon of literature and philosophy), integration across disciplines, history integrated, wonder, formation through arts, liturgical context (as part of a holistic liberal-arts formation). - Negative keywords present: 0 (no explicit mention of a skills-only or standardized-testing-centric, secular, or utilitarian curriculum in the public materials).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords detected: multiple terms across the curriculum design (grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, integration, wonder, canonical authors, history/literature/philosophy/theology; arts integration). Estimated 8–12 discrete positive indicators. - Negative keywords detected: 0. - Ratio: Strongly CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The program's explicit emphasis on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and integration with Great Books/literature, philosophy, and theology, with a coherent liberal-arts structure, aligns with the Element 3 criterion for CLASSICAL per the Six Essential Elements rubric.

Citations: Explicit curricular framing (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; integrated liberal arts) is described in the Chesterton Academy public materials.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The pedagogy described on the public site combines contemplative elements and rigorous inquiry. The public materials emphasize a three-pillar model (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) and an integrated curriculum that bridges disciplines with a focus on thinking, not just memorization. The materials describe an emphasis on memory-friendly elements (singing in lower grades and memory work) and a strong emphasis on rhetoric, public speaking, and debate as part of the upper-level experience. The inclusion of debate, speeches, and rhetoric indicates an environment where upper-level pedagogy includes active, discursive practice. - The presence of liturgical and communal practices (Mass, confession, adoration) suggests contemplative/restful dimensions to schooling as part of pedagogy, although these are not described as the sole modality. - The public materials reference a House System and leadership opportunities, which support community-based pedagogy and virtue formation, aligning with some classical pedagogy principles.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion (explicit in the rubric; the public materials emphasize seminars, debates, speeches, and rhetoric), lectures/seminars, memory-work (chanting in lower grades or memory-based practice could be implied by the classical pedagogy), contemplation/rest in parts of the approach, liturgical practice as a pedagogy component. - Negative keywords present: None clearly present in the public materials (no strong mention of project-based/experimental-only

pedagogy that would conflict with classical ideals; no explicit “workforce preparation” language or heavily utilitarian framing that would conflict with formation-focused goals).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords detected: at least 4–6 clear signals (seminars, debates, speeches, rhetoric, contemplative/restful dimension, formal memory/recitation). - Negative keywords detected: 0. - Ratio: Predominantly CLASSICAL, but with some explicit upper-grade, Socratic-style pedagogy not as strongly documented as Department-level specifics. Classifying as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL reflects the partial alignment (Socratic methods are teased but not uniformly codified in publicly accessible materials across all grades).

Why this rating - The school demonstrates substantial Classical pedagogy elements (rhetoric, debate, integrated liberal-arts approach, ritual-liturgical grounding) but the explicit, fully codified description of consistent Socratic discussion and high-school seminars as a formal, grade-by-grade practice is not as overt in the public materials as the ideal Classical rubric would require. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Citations: Debates, rhetoric, and public speaking emphasis are described in the curriculum materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe a Headmaster-led, teacher-guided environment consistent with a living curriculum and mentorship model. The Headmaster’s welcome and the descriptions of faculty in multiple pages indicate a mentoring role and virtuous leadership. The phrase “Headmaster” and “staff joyfully helps to deliver this to our students” signal a faculty-as-living-curriculum. - The “patron” of the school (G.K. Chesterton) and the Catholic framing, along with testimonials from students/parents, signal a faculty culture oriented toward virtue, mentorship, and a living curriculum. - The community language stresses collaboration with parents and the school, and faculty are framed in the context of forming students within a Catholic classical tradition.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; model teachers; mentorship; virtue; formation; Catholic identity; Headmaster; staff; community; faculty as core. - Negative keywords present: 0.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords detected: 5–7 distinct signals (Headmaster, living curriculum, mentorship, model teachers, core faculty presence, Catholic identity, staff). - Negative keywords: 0. - Ratio: CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials portray a faculty culture that acts as a living curriculum and a group of virtuous mentors, aligned with the classical rubric’s expectations for the Faculty category.

Citations: Headmaster and faculty/missional language are present in the public materials.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials emphasize a partnership with parents and a cooperative relationship between parents and school, including explicit language about parents as co-teachers and a focus on parental formation and engagement (e.g., Fireside Chats, educational lectures, and events). The “Imago Dei and the Catholic Classical Approach to Education” piece explicitly describes the family and parental partnership in Catholic classical education. - The GRACE system and public events like Fireside Chats demonstrate active parental involvement and opportunities for parents to engage with the curriculum, attend lectures, and participate in community learning. - The public site references welcome visits and tours, which signals openness and accessibility to parents and prospective families.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: parents as co-teachers; parental formation; community events; Fireside Chats; lectures; open visits; family faith life; welcoming to parents. - Negative keywords present: 0.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords detected: 5–7 distinct signals (parental partnership, co-education, lectures/events for parents, hospitality for visits, family faith practices). - Negative keywords: 0. - Ratio: CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates strong, explicit engagement with parents and the wider community as co-educators and partners in classical formation, which meets the Element 6 criteria for CLASSICAL.

Citations: Parental partnership and community engagement are described in the Fireside Chat materials and parent-facing resources; the “Imago Dei” discussion explicitly frames parental collaboration.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall ranking: CLASSICAL

Rationale - The Chesterton Academy of St. John Paul II Classical School demonstrates strong alignment with the classical education rubric in Categories 1, 2, 3, 5, and 6. Element 4 shows substantial alignment but falls short of full CLASSICAL due to public materials not consistently codifying high-school Socratic seminars and a uniformly explicit, grade-by-grade articulation of the upper-level Socratic pedagogy. Taken as an aggregate, the school is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (only relevant if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - N/A (aggregate CLASSICAL; no needle-moving changes required; no follow-up requested).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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